

Simulated Incident Report — #2

Wazuh / Suricata Detection Lab

01 Alert Summary

INCIDENT #	SIM-002	DATE / TIME	Aug 12, 2026 04:08:56
ATTACK TYPE	Unauthorized Privilege Escalation Attempt (Sudo)	SEVERITY	Low severity, Rule Level 5
SOURCE	Local (testuser account, same host)	DESTINATION	54.84.165.65 (VM)
DETECTING TOOL	Wazuh — sudo rule group, decoded from /var/log/auth.log		

02 Initial Triage

Alert generated from a sudo invocation by an account without sudoers privileges. First questions: is this a legitimate user who mistakenly believes they have elevated access, a misconfigured account, or a deliberate escalation attempt? Confirmed the account (testuser) was a newly created test account with no business justification for sudo access.

03 Investigation Steps

Reviewed /var/log/auth.log and confirmed the exact denial message ("user is not in the sudoers file. This incident will be reported.") tied to the testuser account. Checked for any prior successful sudo activity or account modification attempts from the same session — none found. Confirmed the account was intentionally created for this test and had no legitimate administrative role.

04 Verdict

TRUE POSITIVE

FALSE POSITIVE

Confirmed unauthorized privilege escalation attempt. The account explicitly lacked sudo entitlement, and the attempt was correctly denied and logged by the system.

05 MITRE ATT&CK

TECH ID#	NAME	TACTIC
T1548.003	Sudo and Sudo Caching	Privilege Escalation, Defense Evasion

06 Escalation

Closed at Tier 1. A low blast-radius attempt was denied at the OS level and no privilege was actually gained. Would escalate to Tier 2/IR if the same account showed a successful sudo afterward, or if this pattern originated from a production service account rather than a test account.

07 Response / Remediation

No production impact as it was a test account. In a live environment: would investigate why the account attempted sudo access at all, review the account's provisioning history, and consider disabling the account pending review.

08 Lessons Learned / Tuning

Confirmed Wazuh does not alert on routine successful sudo usage by authorized users by default — only failed/unauthorized attempts triggered a rule. This is a sensible default (avoids alert fatigue on normal admin activity) but worth noting as a documented behavior, not a detection gap, for future rule-tuning discussions.